INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Market Planning

ENTREPRENEURSHIP TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the concept of marketing strategies.
2. Set marketing goals and objectives.
3. Develop marketing plan.
4. Build product/service brand.
5. Identify communications channels used in sales promotion.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of co-founders of EMBER & OAK, a small business that makes hot sauce in small batches. Your business partner (judge) wants your team to create a marketing plan for a big new opportunity.

EMBER & OAK started three years ago and sells hot sauce at four local farmers markets for $9 a bottle. Last year the company sold 1,800 bottles. Customers love tasting samples at the booth and talking with the founders about how the sauce is made.

A regional grocery chain with 22 stores has offered EMBER & OAK shelf space for a six-month trial. To stay on the shelves, the sauce must sell at least 30 bottles per store each month. In the grocery store, the sauce will sit on a crowded shelf next to well-known national brands that cost $4 to $6. The founders won't be there to tell the story behind the product.

Your business partner (judge) is excited but nervous that EMBER & OAK will get lost on the shelf. Your business partner (judge) wants your team to:

- Explain what a marketing strategy is and recommend one for the grocery launch.
- Set marketing goals and objectives for the six-month trial.
- Outline the main parts of a marketing plan for the launch.
- Explain how to build the EMBER & OAK brand when shoppers can't meet the founders.
- Identify communications channels to promote the sauce in and around the grocery stores.

You will present your ideas to your business partner (judge) in a meeting at your kitchen workspace. Your business partner (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered your business partner's (judge's) questions, your business partner (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How much of our time and money should go into in-store sampling compared with social media?
2. Our sauce costs more than the national brands. Why would a shopper pick ours?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the concept of marketing strategies.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Set marketing goals and objectives.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Develop marketing plan.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Build product/service brand.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Identify communications channels used in sales promotion.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	